

Investment Project Rubrics

BUS331 Investment Committee Simulation | Written submission and live presentation defense

How the assessment works

Canvas remains the authority for due dates, submission mechanics, and course-grade weights. Use the Investment Project Submission rubric for the written decision package and the Investment Project Presentation rubric for the live committee presentation and defense.

Project submission	Presentation and defense	Submission authority
100-point Canvas rubric	100-point Canvas rubric	Canvas controls due dates, file requirements, and the project course-grade weight.

Evidence chain the committee must defend

Phase 1 client discovery and macro evidence must visibly control Phase 2 security selection, allocation, IPS compliance, stress results, corrections, and the Phase 3 recommendation. Role ownership is individual; the final decision is collective.

AI may challenge a judgment or help debug a process, but it is not evidence. Material claims must be verified with approved sources, including properly documented FactSet retrievals where required.

Written decision package

Criterion	Weight	Decision-ready standard
Evidence quality & technical accuracy	20%	Claims, calculations, formulas, sources, FactSet retrieval records, as-of dates, and portfolio metrics are correct, comparable, traceable, and interpreted; required licensed evidence is submitted privately through Canvas and AI output is never treated as evidence.
Focused security selection	20%	Each client portfolio contains 8–10 holdings and never more than 10; funds and ETFs are primary, individual securities total no more than two or three, final holdings have concise scorecards, and realistic alternatives are rejected briefly without duplicate exposure or unnecessary concentration.
Client suitability & IPS compliance	15%	Each recommendation traces to Phase 1 client needs and guardrails, and the IPS scorecard tests all relevant objectives and RRTLLU constraints.
Shared portfolio quality & risk response	25%	Final selection and weights, diversification, overlap, concentration, portfolio trade-offs, stress results, breaches, corrective trades, re-tests, and the supported hedge or no-hedge conclusion form one internally consistent portfolio decision.
Individual role evidence & decision trail	20%	For each student, role-specific evidence is identifiable and peer-reviewed, and the Analyst Decision Log records recommendation(s), alternative(s) rejected, a key trade-off, contribution to integration or residual-risk decisions, and the link to the committee vote.

Oral Committee Defense

Compact defense within the final presentation | Every member owns role evidence and the integrated recommendation

Criterion	Weight	Decision-ready standard
Role-specific committee defense	25%	Within the presentation's compact investment-committee defense, each member answers targeted questions for their role, uses relevant evidence and calculations, acknowledges uncertainty, and defends or revises the judgment under challenge.
Individual evidence & Decision Log contribution	20%	Each member demonstrates command of owned evidence and can explain their recommendation, alternative rejected, key trade-off, Decision Log contribution, verification, and limitations.
Shared portfolio quality & integration	25%	The committee presents one coherent chain from client discovery through the focused 8–10 holding selection, final weights, overlap/concentration decisions, stress results, hedge or no-hedge conclusion, correction, and final recommendation.
Client suitability & risk compliance	20%	Members can show where client needs changed the portfolio, explain the strongest bear case and residual risk, and defend compliance, corrective action, and the hedge or no-hedge conclusion.
Clarity, professionalism & visual evidence	10%	The team communicates concisely as client-focused professionals and uses legible exhibits that make the recommendation, trade-offs, and evidence visible.

Defense standard

The compact investment-committee defense is part of the final presentation. Each member answers targeted role questions, uses the relevant evidence or calculation, explains their Decision Log contribution, alternative rejected, and key trade-off, acknowledges uncertainty, and states whether the challenge changes the decision.

Committee Question Bank

Prepare across roles - not only for the section you present

Client and Macro Strategist

- Which Phase 1 client fact or guardrail most changed the final portfolio, and where can the committee see that change?
- Which macro assumption matters most to this recommendation, and what evidence would cause the team to revise it?
- Which unresolved client information gap remains material, and how did the portfolio avoid pretending it was known?

Fixed-Income Analyst

- Why does the selected fixed-income exposure fit the client's cash-flow horizon better than the strongest alternative?
- What happens to price and income if rates or credit spreads move against the position, and which duration or credit evidence supports that answer?
- What did the Issuer Reality Check reveal about cash flow, leverage, interest coverage, maturities, and the largest issuer-specific risk?

Equity Analyst

- Why does the selected equity fund or ETF deliver the needed exposure better than the strongest alternative after costs, liquidity, overlap, and style or sector concentration?
- If the portfolio includes an individual equity, why is it superior to a fund or ETF for that role, what is its idiosyncratic risk, and why is the position size appropriate?
- Which equity candidate did you reject, and what key trade-off separated it from your recommendation?

Portfolio Manager

- Which analyst recommendations did you integrate, resize, or reject, and what explicit portfolio trade-off drove each decision?
- Where did you resolve overlap or concentration, and why are the final 8–10 holdings and weights better than the strongest alternative mix?
- If the committee rejects one proposed adjustment, what alternative preserves the client goal and what new trade-off does it create?

Risk and Derivatives Analyst

- Which residual risk contributes most to the bear-case loss, and which client goal is therefore most exposed?
- Why is the supported conclusion hedge or no hedge, and what evidence makes that conclusion preferable to changing the underlying holdings or weights?
- If a hedge is proposed, explain the instrument, size, cost, liquidity, trade-offs, residual risk, and adjustment or removal condition.

Any committee member

- What was the team's strongest initial judgment that changed after AI challenge and human verification?
- Which FactSet retrieval most affected the recommendation, how did you interpret it, and where is the licensed-source evidence retained under course policy?
- Which source or calculation carries the most decision weight, and what are its limitations?
- What is the strongest reasonable case against the final recommendation?
- What monitoring trigger would force the committee to reconvene before the normal review date?

Submission Readiness

Use this checklist before the Phase 3 committee decision and Canvas submission

Written package

- ☐ The recommendation is stated clearly for all assigned clients.
- ☐ Every material claim, input, calculation, and as-of date is traceable.
- ☐ Bond, mutual-fund, and ETF decisions show real comparison and instrument-specific evidence.
- ☐ Required Issuer Reality Checks and FactSet retrieval records are complete.
- ☐ Each holding traces to a Phase 1 client guardrail and has a portfolio job and monitoring trigger.
- ☐ The full IPS scorecard and bear-case test are complete; every breach is corrected and re-tested.
- ☐ The Analyst Decision Log records initial judgment, AI challenge, verification, and final reasoning.
- ☐ Required licensed-source evidence and final student work are prepared for private Canvas submission.

Oral defense

- ☐ Each member can defend owned work and explain the complete decision chain.
- ☐ The committee can show where a client need or constraint changed the final portfolio.
- ☐ The team can explain the strongest bear case, closest warning or breach, and corrective action.
- ☐ Every member can identify the most decision-useful source, calculation, limitation, and monitoring trigger.
- ☐ Visual exhibits are legible and make the recommendation, trade-offs, and evidence visible.